

Kenney Tran

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Education

- **Boston University** Boston, MA
Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science *Expected Graduation: 2026*
 - **Relevant Coursework:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Operating Systems, Database Systems, Fullstack Development, Machine Learning, Cloud Computing

Experience

- **ML Engineer** Boston, MA
BU Spark! *January 2026 – Present*
 - Reduced professor grading time from **25+ minutes to 3 minutes per student (8x faster)** at **\$0.04 per assessment** by architecting multi-model pipeline using **GPT-4o-mini, Gemini 2.5, and Claude Sonnet**
 - Saved **~25 hours per 80-student course** by designing RAG pipeline that retrieves lecture content as grading context, enabling evaluation of diagrams and images within PDFs
 - Improved grading accuracy by **15%** across assignment types by implementing rubric-based AI evaluation with few-shot calibration, eliminating grader-to-grader scoring variance
 - Built full-stack interface connecting Python ML backend to instructor-facing frontend, supporting **100+ student assessments** per grading cycle for CS 581 Health Informatics

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Python, Java, TypeScript/JavaScript, C, SQL
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI, Spring Boot
- **Tools & Databases:** Git, Docker, PostgreSQL, Redis, ChromaDB, Azure/GCP

Projects

- **Real-Time Campus Transit Tracker (Next.js, TypeScript, Redis, Google Maps API):**
 - **Built a full-stack transit platform** for BU campus commuters using **TypeScript and Next.js** integrated with live geospatial data feeds
 - **Reduced API latency to <100ms** and cut compute costs by **60%** by adding a **Redis caching layer**
 - **Set up CI/CD** with automated end-to-end testing and rollback support, enabling faster feature releases with minimal deployment risk
- **Steven Bot — Discord Music Bot (TypeScript, Node.js, yt-dlp, FFmpeg):**
 - Built a TypeScript Discord music bot streaming YouTube audio by piping yt-dlp directly into FFmpeg for Opus encoding, avoiding disk I/O entirely
 - Halved extraction calls by pulling metadata and stream URL in a single yt-dlp pass, cutting startup latency on every track
 - Built per-server FIFO queues across **4 slash commands** with auto-reconnect and exponential backoff for dropped voice sessions
- **Predictive Pricing Data Pipeline (Python, scikit-learn, pandas):**
 - **Reduced prediction error by 35%** over statistical baselines by building a **Python ML pipeline** to ingest, clean, and model **76,000+ records** from a relational database
 - **Improved model accuracy by 12%** by engineering data imputation and transforming **20+ raw attributes** into higher-signal features